

Danbee Kim, PhD

Neuroscientist | Teacher | Storyteller | Chef



taunsquared



www.danbeekim.org



danbee@alum.mit.edu

SUMMARY

Researcher specializing in systems neurobiology and history of neuroscience. 15+ years of experience neuroanatomy & physiology in highly diverse settings. Expert storyteller well-versed in communicating complex ideas through engaging multi-sensory experiences. Chef specializing in vegan, gluten-free, and nut-free Korean-American cuisine. Led large collaborations to self-publish a sci-fi graphic novel and to create an interactive aquarium exhibit that engaged over 24,000 visitors.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

2024 to 2025: **Co-director** and **founding member** of **Pulse & Pickle**, a **plant-based restaurant, live performance venue**, and **community cultural centre** in east London.

- Co-created a programme of accessible events to promote local migrant cultures, nurture communal nourishment and resilience, and contribute to a network of mutual aid.
- Designed and maintained organization website, managed event collaborators, and developed allergy-safe recipes as a chef.

2023 to 2024: **Lead Instructor** at **Matter Neuroscience**, a tech company that aims to **help people better understand and use their neurological reward systems**.

- Led strategic planning, development, and delivery of educational content and resources.
- Provided excellent neuroscience education to teammates, social media audiences, user communities, and other stakeholders.

2018 to 2023: **Co-founder, organizer**, and **teacher** of **Neuronautas**, a **2-week project-based summer program** that empowers young people to follow their curiosity, question what is familiar to them, and confront the unknown.

- Nurtured connections with the Champalimaud Centre for the Unknown (CCU) and secured funding from the Fundação Calouste Gulbenkian to operate as an Academia Gulbenkian do Conhecimento hosted at the CCU.
- Developed and delivered neurobiology and philosophy of science curriculum.
- Assisted in developing and delivering a complimentary robotics curriculum.
- Managed teams of volunteer TAs and launched a Junior TA program for alumni.

2018 to 2020: **Author, Illustrator**, and **Project Manager** of **The First VIRS**, an **original YA sci-fi graphic novel** that weaves PhD research into a narrative accessible to non-academic audiences.

- Recruited, hired, and project managed 16 other illustrators.
- Composed, performed, and recorded a companion original soundtrack
- Liased with editors, administrators, beta-readers, Kickstarter funders, and a printing company to self-publish a printed edition that has sold over 200 copies to date.

2017 to 2020: **Scientific and Artistic Director** of **Surprising Minds**, an **interactive aquarium exhibit that engaged over 24,000 visitors**.

- Coordinated and project managed collaborators from across academia and industry, including Sea Life Brighton (host aquarium), Sainsbury-Wellcome Centre for Neural Circuits and Behaviour, Nuffield Research Placements, and University of Sussex.
- Successfully benchmarked eye-tracking as a robust method for non-invasively capturing observable measurements of nervous system activity in complex natural contexts.

EDUCATION

2013 to 2020
Lisboa, Portugal

Champalimaud Centre for the Unknown

PhD in Neuroscience, International Neuroscience Doctoral Programme

2005 to 2009
Cambridge, USA

Massachusetts Institute of Technology

BSc in Brain and Cognitive Sciences (9)

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RELEVANT SKILLS

Digital tools:

- **Programming languages:** Python (inc. numpy, scipy, OpenCV, matplotlib), Bonsai-Rx, Arduino
- **Web development | Collaboration:** CSS, HTML, JS, Markdown | Discord, git, GWorkspace
- **Content creation & editing software:** Illustrator, LaTeX, Photoshop, Premier Pro

Live Performance:

- **Theatre:** cast member, pit orchestra musician, stage director, choreographer, vocal director, costume designer, prop designer, backstage crew
- **Musician:** violin, ukelele, bass guitar, upright bass, cello, djembe, vocals
- **Circus and Fire Performance:** poi, ropedart

Organized | Prioritization | Multi-tasking:

- **Able to work under pressure and meet tight deadlines**, e.g. developed and performed new live interpretations on strict 3-week cycles as a presenter at the Boston Museum of Science
- **Able to juggle multiple projects and adapt as needed**, e.g. led events working group at Pulse & Pickle while updating company website and working both kitchen and front of house shifts
- **Excellent attention to detail and accuracy**, e.g. doctoral dissertation accepted on first submission with zero corrections

Interpersonal skills | Teamwork:

- **Able to establish working relationships with people at all levels**, e.g. client exec teams, external contractors, target audiences, and internal teammates for collaborations/commissions
- **Able to understand needs and pressures of different audiences**, e.g. teaching neuroscience to designers and engineers vs. facilitating workshops to support adult survivors of sexual abuse

Pro-active | Quick learner | Work independently:

- **Self-starter and pro-active**, e.g. initiated numerous cross-disciplinary cross-sector collaborations and integrated these perspectives to establish "field neuroscience", or neuroscience *in situ*
- **Able to learn quickly**, e.g. built Discord community spaces and custom interactive websites to convert in-person summer camps into online/remote experiences during COVID-19 lockdowns
- **Able to work independently**, e.g. PhD research projects and doctoral dissertation

RELEVANT EMPLOYMENT

2024 to 2025 London, UK	Pulse & Pickle Co-director, Events, Website, Chef
2023 to 2024 London, UK	Matter Neuroscience Lead Instructor
2021 to 2023 London, UK	NeuroGEARS, Ltd Research and Outreach Scientist
2020 to 2022 London, UK	Bartlett School of Architecture, UCL Tutor and Masters Thesis Advisor
2010 to present Mars Hill, USA	Appalachian Institute for Creative Learning Teacher, Staff, Board member (2020 to 2024)

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PUBLICATIONS

- Danbee Kim. "Are cephalopods making a comeback in neuroscience?". *BioTechniques*. 22 Jun 2022.
- Kim, Danbee, Kendra C. Buresch, Roger T. Hanlon, and Adam R. Kampff. "An experimental method for evoking and characterizing dynamic color patterning of cuttlefish during prey capture." *Journal of Biological Methods* 9, no. 2 (2022): e161. DOI: 10.14440/jbm.2022.386
- Kim, D. (2020) *The First VIRS*. London, UK: Danbee Kim.
- Kim, D. (2020) On the aims and methods of field neuroscience. PhD dissertation. Universidade Nova de Lisboa. DOI: 10.13140/RG.2.2.35235.11042
- Kim, Danbee, and Adam R. Kampff. "Neuroscience Does Design: What the Brain's Architecture Can Teach Architects." *Architectural Design* 90.6 (2020): 94-99.
- Marques-Smith, André, Joana P. Neto, Gonçalo Lopes, Joana Nogueira, Lorenza Calcaterra, João Frazão, Danbee Kim, Matthew G. Phillips, George Dimitriadis, and Adam R. Kampff. "Recording from the same neuron with high-density CMOS probes and patch-clamp: a ground-truth dataset and an experiment in collaboration." *BioRxiv* (2018): 370080.
- Kim, D. (2018, June 18). Why I refuse to do animal testing in my science career. Massive Science. <https://massivesci.com/articles/frankenstein-kim-animal-testing/>
- Quiñones, Darío R., Gonçalo Lopes, Danbee Kim, Cédric Honnet, David Moratal, and Adam Kampff. "HIVE Tracker: a tiny, low-cost, and scalable device for sub-millimetric 3D positioning." In *Proceedings of the 9th Augmented Human International Conference*, pp. 1-8. 2018.
- Lopes, G., Kim, D. (2017) How theater, startup culture, and business history helped us become better neuroscientists. <https://massivesci.com/articles/neuroscience-can-learn-from-theater/>.
- Kim, D., Lopes, G. (2017) Does modern neuroscience really help us understand behavior? <https://massivesci.com/articles/neuroscience-behavior-vs-technology/>.